

Chapter 12: Bilingual Clinical Role-Play Dialogues

Nutritional Counseling & Cariology Patient Communication (English & Spanish)

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■ SCENARIO 1: High School Athlete with Frequent Sports Drink & Snack Consumption (Case A - Alex)

****Clinical Context****

Alex (17 y/o varsity football player) presents with two new interproximal carious lesions. He drinks Gatorade during practices, energy drinks at night, and snacks on refined carbohydrates while working at an ice cream parlor.

****Dialogue (Bilingual)****

Dental Hygienist (English):

"Alex, we noticed two small new cavities forming between your teeth today. I know you have a demanding football schedule and work at the ice cream shop. Tell me about the drinks and snacks you reach for when you're on the go."

Higienista Dental (Español):

"Alex, hoy notamos dos pequeñas caries nuevas entre tus dientes. Sé que tienes un horario muy exigente con el fútbol y tu trabajo en la heladería. Cuéntame qué bebidas y bocadillos consumes cuando estás fuera de casa."

Alex:

"I drink Gatorade during morning practice and energy drinks in the evening to stay awake for AP homework. Plus, free ice cream at work!"

Dental Hygienist (English):

"Those sports and energy drinks keep your teeth bathed in acid and sugar for hours. Every time you sip a sugary drink, your mouth drops below the critical pH of 5.5, which strips calcium and phosphate from your enamel for 20 to 30 minutes. Switching to water during practices and eating your sweet treats with meals—instead of sipping them all evening—will stop these cavities in their tracks."

Higienista Dental (Español):

"Esas bebidas deportivas y energéticas bañan tus dientes en ácido y azúcar durante horas. Cada vez que tomas un sorbo dulce, el pH de tu boca cae por debajo de 5.5, desmineralizando el esmalte durante 20 a 30 minutos. Cambiar a agua durante los entrenamientos y consumir los dulces junto con las comidas principales detendrá estas caries de inmediato."

■ SCENARIO 2: Geriatric Patient with Medication-Induced Xerostomia & Nighttime Sweets (Case B - Mrs. James)

****Clinical Context****

Mrs. James (67 y/o widow taking Lisinopril and Zoloft) presents with dry mouth, cervical root demineralization, and carious lesions on molars. She uses honey lemon cough drops and eats ice cream in bed without brushing before sleep.

****Dialogue (Bilingual)****

Dental Hygienist (English):

"Mrs. James, your blood pressure medication can reduce your saliva flow, which makes your teeth vulnerable to decay. Because saliva neutralizes mouth acids, sucking on honey-lemon lozenges and enjoying ice cream in bed without brushing exposes your root surfaces to continuous acid attack."

Higienista Dental (Español):

"Sra. James, sus medicamentos para la presión pueden disminuir la saliva, haciendo que sus dientes sean vulnerables a las caries. Como la saliva neutraliza los ácidos, chupar pastillas con miel y comer helado en la cama sin cepillarse expone las raíces dentales a un ataque ácido continuo."

Mrs. James:

"My throat is so dry at night, but I get too tired to get out of bed and brush."

Dental Hygienist (English):

"Let's switch your cough drops to sugar-free xylitol lozenges, which actually fight cavity-causing bacteria. Keep a water bottle by your bedside instead of sugary tea, and we will prescribe a high-fluoride 5000 ppm toothpaste to remineralize those root surfaces before you go to sleep."

Higienista Dental (Español):

"Cambiemos las pastillas de miel por pastillas sin azúcar con xilitol, las cuales combaten las bacterias causantes de caries. Tenga agua fresca junto a su cama en lugar de té con azúcar, y le recetaremos una pasta de alto contenido de flúor (5000 ppm) para remineralizar sus raíces antes de dormir."